

7 October 2026

Dear Editor,

We resubmit “Does AI rate through the cycle? Procyclical in credit assessment” to *Finance Research Letters*. The three reports were detailed and have improved the paper; all sixteen comments are answered point by point. The revision adds a real-fundamentals arm using FY2024 data for 80 SEC filers, where the procyclical slope replicates in every model with all intervals excluding zero; two frontier models, taking the design to seven across two families; and three further replicate seeds re-measured 2.5 months later, bounding coefficient drift at 0.037 notches. The central finding is unchanged: every model is significantly procyclical, and an explicit “through-the-cycle” instruction anchors the rating while suppressing the default probability that should keep moving.

Where a referee’s request produced a result that does not help us, we report it—issuer recall identifies seven of forty real firms, which we decline to read as equivalence, and the three extra-seed captures refused by the pre-registered error-rate gate are disclosed with their causes. A complete replication archive accompanies the paper: one command regenerates every reported number and binds it to the artifact that produced it (doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21864041). A tracked-changes copy is included.

Thank you for considering the revision.

Sincerely,

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